A-A-50170
July 26, 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

EMBALMING FLUID, CAVITY

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to MIL-E-1439.

1. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

1.1 Material and composition. The finished product shall be clear, homogeneous, free from sediment, and either colorless or of a color other than red or pink shade when observed in a clear glass container. The following ingredients shall be included in the finished formulation, expressed in percent by weight, except for the formaldehyde index number which shall be expressed in grams of formaldehyde per milliliter of solution:

Ingredients	Minimum	Maximum
Formaldehyde index number	24.0	27.0
Alcohol	25.0	35.0
Wetting agent (Triton X-100 or equivalent)	0.5	-

1.2 Prohibited ingredients. The embalming fluid shall contain no more than 5 parts per million of any of the following: antimony, arsenic, lead, mercury, copper, zinc, silver, chloral, cyanide, or alkaloids. Alcohols, other than methanol, ethanol, isopropanol, and ethanol denatured with methanol, shall not be used.

2. QUALITY ASSURANCE

2.1 Formaldehyde index number test. The method for determining the concentration of formaldehyde in embalming fluid shall be in accordance with ASTM D 2194. The specific gravity, apparent, of the embalming fluid shall be determined in accordance with METHOD A of ASTM D 891 when the fluid is 20°C. The specific gravity of the embalming fluid multiplied by the percent formaldehyde concentration equals the formaldehyde index number.

FSC 9930

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2.2 Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description, conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same as the product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

3. PACKAGING

3.1 Packing. Five gallons of embalming fluid shall be packed in cans in accordance with commercial practice.

3.2 Palletization. When specified, embalming fluid, packed as specified, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet, load type XIV in accordance with MIL-STD-147.

3.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers and palletized loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. In addition, the following special markings are required:

Embalming Fluid, Cavity
Flammable
Poison
Formaldehyde Index No. (Add)
Manufacturer's Directions for Use (Add)

Do not Use in Presence of Open Flame

Keep Container Tightly Sealed When Not in Use.

Formaldehyde is a carcinogen in animals and therefore is a suspected carcinogen in humans.

May contain methanol

May contain Triton X-100

Eye protection required when using this material

4. NOTES

4.1 Intended use. This commercial item description covers embalming fluid for mortuary use in the preparation of human remains for burial.

4.2 Ordering data.

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When palletization is required (see 3.2).

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4.3 Sources for nongovernment associations documents.

ASTM D 891 - Specific Gravity, Apparent, of Liquid Industrial Chemicals

ASTM D 2194 - Test Method for Determining the Concentration of Formaldehyde Solutions

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Air Force - 50

Review activities

Army - MD
DLA - GS

User activity

Army - SM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project No. 9930-1001

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